

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: A Possible Job Opportunity



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's backgrounds in a wider variety of communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can write about jobs and work.
- I can write about my attitudes toward an action.
- I can write a résumé.

Ask your partner:

- Applying for a job can be stressful. When was the last time you applied for a job?
- Did you have an interview? What happened?





Let's Explore!

There is a possible job opportunity at Sally's work. Her friend, Susan, is **getting the scoop***.

* "Getting the scoop" means getting the details.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Susan:** Thanks for meeting with me. I'd really love to hear your thoughts on the advertised position.
- Sally:** No problem.
- Susan:** When I saw your e-mail this morning about Paul's termination and the job vacancy, I was a little surprised.
- Sally:** It was a bit of a shock to all of us. Working at *Cambridge Life* meant everything to him. We were told by the Executive Director last week. Anyway, I thought you might be interested in applying. You're still at *The Valley News*, aren't you?
- Susan:** Yes, I worked there as a senior reporter for two years. I'm also completing an MBA, part-time.
- Sally:** A Master in Business Administration? Are you planning to change positions one day?
- Susan:** Actually, I want to move into management.
- Sally:** I see. Paul was part of the management team. It was also mentioned by a few of the senior editors that he was a jack-of-all-trades.
- Susan:** This position might be a great opportunity for me to get my hands dirty. Currently, I'm working on improving my résumé. The deadline is this Friday.
- Sally:** Could you start working right away if you needed to? It's pretty hectic at the moment.
- Susan:** Well ... I do have to give my current employer a resignation letter and 2 weeks' notice. That's what I was told by the lawyer when I signed my contract.
- Sally:** I see.
- Susan:** Will you put in a good word for me?
- Sally:** Absolutely! Make sure that your cover letter and résumé are polished. Starting with your work objectives followed by your relevant work experience is important ... and watch your spelling!
- Susan:** Thanks for your help.



Let's Practice!

Susan and Sally discuss events that commonly happen in a workplace.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence.

1. That's / I / . / the / when / I / contract / what / told / signed / lawyer / by / my / was

2. mentioned / was / by / senior / was / a / of / the / all / a / few / also / Jack / It / he / editors / that / trades / of / .

3. the / signed / was / The / letter / executives / termination / . / by

4. by / the / week / were / Executive / last / . / told / We / Director

5. one / . / hour / by / to / supervisor / given / empty / desk / He / his / the / was



Let's Practice!

What are Susan's work goals and aspirations*? Do you think she could be the right candidate** for the job?

* "Aspirations" are things that a person wants very much to achieve.

** A "candidate" is a person who is being considered for the job.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Circle the incorrect words. Write the correct word above to complete the sentence. Use capital letters where necessary.

1. I work there as an senior reporter for two years.

2. This position might be a greet oportunity for me to get my hands dirty.

3. Could you star woking right away if you needed to?

4. Will you put in a good world for me?

5. Make sure that your cover leter and resume are polishing.





Extension Activity

Are you in the job market? It's time to work on your résumé.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or look in your local newspaper to find a job vacancy you might be interested in.
- Create or change your current résumé to suit the job vacancy.
- Include an Objective Statement, Education, Skills, and Interests.
- Ensure that you include your contact details and those of your reference.
- Read your résumé aloud to a partner.
- Make a list of the requirements of the position. Do you have the education and skills they are looking for? What could you do to become a stronger candidate?

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I identify a potential job opportunity online or in a newspaper.

☐ ☐

I write a résumé that includes my education, skills and interests.

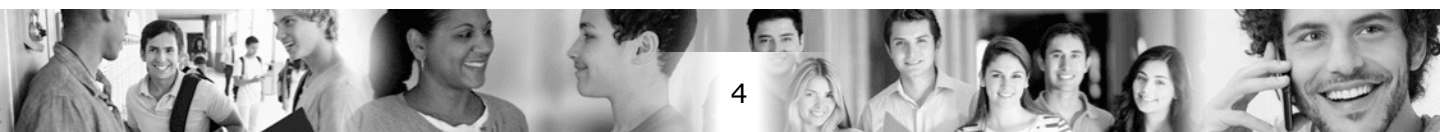
☐ ☐

I make a list of the job requirements and compare them to my qualifications and skills.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- polished** (adjective): very impressive or skillful
e.g. Make sure that your cover letter and resume are polished.
- hectic** (adjective): very busy and filled with activity
e.g. It's pretty hectic at the moment.
- objective** (noun): a goal or purpose
e.g. Starting with your work objectives followed by your relevant work experience is important.
- termination** (noun): the act of making a person leave a job; the act of firing or dismissing someone
e.g. I saw your e-mail this morning about Paul's termination.
- resignation letter** (noun): a letter giving up a job or position in a formal or official way
e.g. Have you written the resignation letter yet?
- notice** (noun): a statement telling someone that a job will end soon
e.g. I have to give my employer 2 weeks' notice.
- contract** (noun): a legal agreement
e.g. A lawyer helped me to understand the contract.
- jack-of-all-trades** (expression): a person who has many skills
e.g. It was also mentioned by a few of the senior editors that he was a jack-of-all-trades.
- get my hands dirty** (expression): to do hard work
e.g. I want to get in and get my hands dirty.





Learning Points

Verb + *-ing* and *to* + verb

A gerund is a noun made from a verb by adding "*-ing*". You can use a gerund as the subject, the complement, or the object of a sentence.

The infinitive is the base form of a verb - "*to* + verb".

A gerund is an action verb that is acting as a noun. The noun refers to an activity instead of a person or thing. Gerunds are written in their *-ing* form. You can use a gerund as the subject, the complement, or the object of a sentence.

Example:

Reading helps your comprehension and vocabulary. (subject of sentence)

Justin's favorite pastime is **reading**. (complement of sentence)

He enjoys **reading**. (object of sentence)

An infinitive is a verb form that acts as other parts of speech in a sentence. It is formed with *to* + base form of the verb.

Example: *to talk, to enjoy, to play*

You **cannot** add *s, es, ed, or ing* to the end. It is not a verb.

Examples:

- *Could you start working right away?*
- *What do you expect to have with this new job?*
- *Studying is a great way to stay in front of the game.*
- *I enjoy learning about new technology in my industry.*





Learning Points

Writing a Résumé

You write a résumé to give a potential employer an understanding of your education, work experience, credentials and accomplishments. It is a very important piece of a job application.

Your résumé should look professional. Don't make it too long. Employers generally prefer that a résumé fits on one page.

A résumé should include:

- Name and contact information
- Objective or summary statement (this means that you explain what type of position you're looking for and your employment goals)
- Work experience
- Volunteer and extracurricular experience
- Education
- Skills

When you write a résumé, only include clear, short descriptions. You do not have to write full sentences.

You should adjust your résumé each time you apply for a position. A résumé should feature the items that are most important for the position.

Make sure to add new experiences and skills to keep your résumé current.

